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World's First Incident of Intercepting an Enemy Nation's Satellite in Orbit

US Satellite Shadowed in Space

Kyiv, Oct 19

The ongoing Russia-Ukraine conflict has escalated into outer space as Russia's Cosmos-2912 satellite actively stalked the US radar satellite ICEYE-X36 assisting Ukraine. This unprecedented orbital pursuit has sparked grave concern over satellite security. Defense experts say this marks the first instance in modern warfare of one nation's satellite shadowing an adversary's spacecraft.

Russian Satellite Stalks US Radar Spacecraft Supplying Real-Time Drone and Missile Targeting Data to Ukraine

Ukrainian defense advisor Beskrestnov described Russia's expanding satellite network as the single biggest threat in the ongoing war. The Russian spacecraft closely pursued the American radar satellite providing real-time targeting data for Ukrainian drones and missiles, attempting to encircle the US craft in orbit and disrupt critical intelligence feeds to Kyiv's forces.

Space tracking scientists recorded that the Russian satellite repeatedly altered its orbital altitude to maneuver dangerously close to the US spacecraft. On October 7, the two satellites closed to within a distance of just 1 to 2 kilometers apart. In orbital mechanics, such proximity is considered perilously close. Low-Earth orbit satellites travel at nearly 27,000 kilometers per hour, meaning even a minor trajectory shift risks a catastrophic high-speed collision.

Although the Russian satellite did not physically strike the American radar satellite, analysts warn Russia could jam or blind spacecraft supplying real-time missile guidance to Ukraine. Any direct attack on a US-operated satellite would risk triggering a direct orbital confrontation between Washington and Moscow

(Cont. on Page 9)

Russian Satellite 'Rassvet' Enables Real-Time Drone & Missile Control, Neutralizing Ukrainian Electronic Warfare

Russia Fires 16 Ballistic Missiles at Ukraine

Allied Nations No Longer Sharing Timely Intelligence: Zelenskyy

(PTI) **Kyiv, Oct 19**

Russia launched a fresh wave of strikes targeting Ukraine's energy infrastructure using ballistic missiles and jet-powered drones, Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy stated on Monday.

Zelenskyy revealed that Ukraine received no prior intelligence warning from partner nations ahead of the barrage, whereas Western allies previously shared such early alerts routinely. He added that Washington's recent relaxation on Russian diesel purchases has emboldened Putin while compounding Kyiv's defense challenges. Posting on social media, Zelenskyy said the overnight Russian strikes damaged critical power

(Cont. on Page 9)

Massive Russian Strikes Hit Ukrainian Energy Grid; Over Five Lakh Citizens Left Without Electricity

Russia-Ukraine Space War Reaches Peak



Dussehra symbolizes the eternal triumph of truth over falsehood and righteousness over evil. On this auspicious day, effigies of Ravana, Meghnada and Kumbhakarna are consigned to flames. Rooted in the epic Ramayana, this tradition is not merely a religious festivity but a profound call for human introspection. Ravana was a learned scholar and mighty ruler, yet his arrogance, obstinacy and transgression of moral boundaries led to his downfall. His life reminds us that even supreme knowledge, power and wealth cannot save a person who loses wisdom and restraint. Ravana's ten heads represent lust, anger, greed, delusion, pride and other destructive human vices. These inner flaws corrode not only personal character but also social harmony. Burning Ravana's effigy becomes truly meaningful only when we pledge to conquer the vices within ourselves—and stand firmly against corruption, discrimination, hatred and the abuse of power in society.

DELHI DIARY

SIR Row: Kiren Rijiju and Shashi Tharoor Cross Swords

New Delhi, Oct 19

Congress MP Shashi Tharoor hit back sharply at Union Minister Kiren Rijiju over his remarks regarding ongoing protests against the Special Intensive Revision (SIR). Tharoor asserted that India is neither Bangladesh nor France. Emphasizing that the opposition never condones violence, he stated that their sole demand is for free, fair and transparent elections. Unlike the violent unrest in France involving the torching of buses and police stations, India's opposition parties firmly believe in peaceful democratic protest. Rijiju had earlier posted on social media

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Trump Adopts Softer Stance on India's Purchase of Russian Crude Oil

India-US Trade Deal in Final Stage: US Secretary of State

Washington, Oct 19

A landmark bilateral trade agreement between India and the United States is likely to be sealed soon, US Secretary of State Marco Rubio announced on Monday. Ahead of his official visit to India, Rubio stated that both nations are actively working to finalize the comprehensive trade pact.

Beyond Trade, High-Level Talks Likely to Cover Defense, Critical Technology, Energy Security and Strategic Ties

Explaining Washington's decision to defer the proposed 100 percent secondary tariff on five major buyers of Russian crude oil including India, Secretary of State Marco Rubio noted that waivers were granted in recent months to prevent severe disruptions to global oil supply and prices. Maintaining market stability required postponing the punitive tariff measure. Both India and the United States are now very close to concluding their bilateral trade agreement.

However, differences reportedly persist over market access in the dairy sector. While the US seeks wider entry for American dairy products in India, New Delhi remains firm on protecting domestic farmers. US Secretary of State Marco Rubio is scheduled to arrive in India and meet External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar in Mumbai on October 20. The two leaders are expected to review the India-US Global Strategic Partnership alongside key bilateral priorities across energy, trade, defense and advanced technology.

FRANKLY -Manjul



Sir, identifying the attackers is very hard—have they never protested against the govt?

AI Teaches Cyber Crime: $5,000 Token Cripples Servers of 100 Firms

See Page No. 13

Two Accused Hail from Haryana, One from Bihar; One Worked as Rapido Rider in Mumbai

Three Shooters Who Fired at Tiger Shroff Nabbed from Train in Kota

(By Our Correspondent) **Mumbai, Oct 19**

Three suspects wanted in the Sunday evening firing outside Bollywood actor Tiger Shroff's residence in Mumbai's Juhu were arrested from a train in Kota, Rajasthan. Rehan alias Sukka, a native of Haryana, opened fire while Ritik Kumar alias Roshan—originally from Bihar and working as a Rapido bike-taxi rider in Mumbai—rode the getaway motorcycle. A third shooter, Phoolsingh, saw his pistol jam at the crucial moment. Though initially claimed to be a minor, Mumbai Police confirmed Phoolsingh is 18 years old.

Fled to Surat by Cab After Juhu Firing; Planned to Reach Delhi by Train and Escape into Nepal

After firing outside the Juhu building, the trio sped toward Andheri, abandoned their motorcycle near Andheri railway station, and boarded a local train to Borivali. From Borivali, they hired a cab to Surat and boarded the Pune-Jaipur Express. Mumbai Police seized the abandoned bike at Andheri and tracked the suspects through CCTV footage, technical surveillance and interstate police coordination. Alerted by Mumbai Crime Branch, Rajasthan Police laid a trap at Kota railway station and nabbed all three within minutes of the train's arrival.



Produced before a local court in Kota, the trio was granted transit remand to be brought back to Mumbai for interrogation. Briefing reporters in Mumbai, DCP Rajtilak Roshan stated that one of the arrested accused is 18 years old while the other two are aged 22. Two of the assailants fired five to six rounds at the

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Historic Market Blockbuster by Reliance's Digital Arm

Jio Platforms Raises Rs 8,110 Crore from Anchor Investors

Mumbai, Oct 19

Jio Platforms, the digital services subsidiary of Reliance Industries, has finalized its share allocation to anchor investors ahead of its much-anticipated Initial Public Offering (IPO), raising Rs 8,110 crore from marquee institutions. According to investment banking sources, Jio's anchor book witnessed unprecedented demand from global and domestic institutional investors, with total bids crossing Rs 2.5 lakh crore.

LIC, BlackRock & GIC Lead Anchor Book; Institutional Investors Place Record Bids Exceeding Rs 2.5 Lakh Crore

This marks the largest institutional demand ever recorded in Indian IPO history. Over 70 global and domestic financial giants participated across 212 investment scheme lines in Jio Platforms' anchor book, including the world's largest sovereign wealth funds, global asset managers, Indian mutual funds, insurance companies and pension funds. Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) emerged as the single largest anchor investor with an allocation of Rs 500 crore.

Global titans BlackRock, Capital International, Fidelity Management, Singapore's sovereign wealth fund GIC, and top domestic mutual funds including SBI Mutual Fund, HDFC Mutual Fund and ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund were allocated shares worth Rs 425 crore each.

Aditya Birla Sun Life MF and Capital World secured Rs 300 crore each, Schroders Rs 293 crore, while Kotak MF, Nippon India MF and Ninety One received Rs 200 crore each, JPMorgan Asset Management Rs 182 crore, and ADIA, QIA, Allianz and Dragoneer invested Rs 150 crore apiece.

A standout feature of Jio Platforms' anchor book is the strong participation of long-only sovereign wealth and pension funds. Alongside GIC, Abu Dhabi Investment Authority (ADIA) and Qatar Investment Authority (QIA), leading international pension funds such as Norway's Norges Bank Investment Management, California State Teachers' Retirement System (CalSTRS) and Florida Retirement System committed substantial capital. Leading Indian insurers and pension funds including HDFC Life, SBI Life, HDFC Pension, SBI Pension and ICICI Prudential also joined.

Global technology specialists and growth-focused funds such as Dragoneer, Janus Henderson and Fidelity's flagship Contrafund also secured allocations in Jio.

Domestically, prominent billionaire family offices showed robust appetite, including Premji Invest (Wipro), the HCL Family Office, Enam Holdings and Zerodha's Rainmatter. The IPO opens for public subscription on October 21.

Following the overwhelming anchor response, market attention now turns to the public issue opening tomorrow.

Jio Platforms plans to deploy the proceeds to expand its next-generation 5G network, cloud computing infrastructure, artificial intelligence (AI) platforms and enterprise digital services. At the upper price band, the issue stands as the largest IPO in Indian capital market history.

Over 2,400 Arrested Amid Violent Nationwide Unrest

Curfew Imposed in French Cities Amid Riots; Macron Hints at Emergency

(PTI) **Paris, Oct 19**

French Prime Minister Sebastien Lecornu has instructed regional prefects to impose targeted local curfews across violence-hit districts. The directive follows weekend riots in which city halls, public buildings and thousands of businesses were vandalized across France.

Over 60,000 Security Personnel Deployed Across France; Trade Unions Call Nationwide Strike on November 5

Speaking after an emergency security meeting with top officials, the Prime Minister remarked that despite widespread arson and heavy property destruction on Saturday night, it was a miracle that no fatalities occurred.

He strongly defended police officers confronting violent mobs and said specific curfew zones would be notified shortly.

The orders came hours after Interior Minister Laurent Nunez tendered his resignation, which President Emmanuel Macron refused to accept.

In an official statement, the Elysee Palace emphasized that maintaining law and order under the current crisis requires Interior Minister Laurent Nunez to remain firmly in command of security operations

(Cont. on Page 9)

Police Fire Tear Gas Shells to Disperse Angry Protesters

Militant Attack in Manipur: Three Poor Villagers Shot Dead

Imphal, Oct 19

Armed militants shot dead three villagers collecting firewood in a forest in Manipur on Monday, leaving three others injured and three more missing. Outraged locals staged a fierce protest and placed two victims' bodies outside the Chief Minister's residence.

Protesters Place Victims' Bodies Outside CM Residence; Three Laborers Injured While Three Others Remain Missing

Officials said heavily armed militants opened indiscriminate fire on a group of villagers gathering firewood along the border of Imphal East and Kangpokpi districts, killing laborers Arubam Ronil (35) and Lairenjam Inaobi (51) on the spot while critically

(Cont. on Page 9)

